considerations of Tamil Nadu politics. Similarly, West Bengal continues to obstruct the finalisation of an India–Bangladesh agreement on the sharing of Teesta waters. Analysts may question as to why Prime Minister Modi remained constrained by state politics like his predecessor UPA regime, when he had a clear and resolute majority in Parliament. The answer may lie in the political aspirations of his BJP, which wants to expand its presence in these provinces, like West Bengal and Tamil Nadu, where it has no standing so far. There are also constituencies within the BJP that may prefer a Hindu state and even a revival of the monarchy in Nepal against the present republican democratic politics, which are vulnerable to radical and communist forces. In the case of Bangladesh, the Modi government's underlying communal approach to the sensitive question of citizenship in Assam and now in the whole of India in the form of the newly adopted Citizenship Amendment Act of 2019 has seriously dented the goodwill earned so far. Bangladesh Prime Minister Hasina has publicly questioned the need and legitimacy of this act.[17]

It is not only the domestic politics of India but also of the neighbouring countries that affect India's neighbourhood policy. India is clearly a politically polarising factor in the turbulent politics of the neighbouring countries. There is no credible national consensus in the neighbouring countries in deciding "how close is not too close" when it comes to engaging with India. The forces and stakeholders that feel uncomfortable with India seek to block Indian initiatives and obstruct their implementation. It would be unfair to hold only India responsible for all its shortcomings on the neighbourhood front. It surely takes two to tango. Recall the instance of the difficulties in the advancement of the BBIN, which faced its first hurdle in Bhutan. There are powerful constituencies in Nepal that may not like to see the success of Indian initiatives. In Sri Lanka, we have mentioned the